AYURBOT

AYURVEDIC & TRADITIONAL HOME-REMEDY KNOWLEDGE BASE

Common diseases • household practices • preparation • evidence • safety

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Important: Educational reference only; not a diagnosis or prescription manual. It distinguishes traditional use from clinical evidence. Not every disease has 3–5 remedies supported by reliable sources. Where evidence or safety is inadequate, remedies and doses are deliberately omitted.

This guide emphasizes ordinary food-level use and low-risk supportive care. It does not provide doses for classical formulations, bhasma, rasa preparations, concentrated extracts or multi-herb medicines. Consult a qualified clinician before medicinal use.

How to use this guide

Traditional use means a practice is described in Ayurveda or household tradition; it does not prove effectiveness. Evidence is specific to the exact product and outcome. Food use is not equivalent to supplements or medicinal doses.

Evidence labels: A strong; B moderate; C limited/preliminary; D traditional use only; E safety/effectiveness uncertain. Most household practices here are supportive care or traditional use, not proven disease treatments.

Why not 3–5 remedies for every disease? Reliable sources do not support that many distinct remedies for most conditions. Listing more would invent efficacy or unsafe recipes. The guide provides fewer where that is the responsible choice.

Universal safety rules

- Never stop prescribed medicines or delay diagnosis to try a remedy.
- Avoid unclear products, metal/mineral preparations, bhasma/rasa and unverified online mixtures.
- Herbs can alter glucose, blood pressure, bleeding, sedation, liver/kidney function and medicine levels.
- Pregnancy, breastfeeding, childhood, older age, liver/kidney disease and planned surgery require extra caution.
- Never put homemade herbal liquids/oils into eyes, ears or nose.
- Never give honey to a child under 12 months.

Conditions covered

Common cold, Cough, Sore throat, Nasal congestion / cold nose, Indigestion, Acidity / acid reflux, Constipation, Diarrhoea, Nausea / mild queasiness, Bloating / gas, Menstrual cramps, Mild muscle soreness, Knee osteoarthritis / chronic knee pain, Minor dry skin, Dandruff, Acne, Minor insect bite itch, Mouth ulcers, Bad breath, Mild nausea in pregnancy, Stress / sleep routine, Minor sprain / strain, Haemorrhoids / piles, Fever, Type 2 diabetes, High blood pressure, Urinary tract infection symptoms, Hair fall, Minor indigestion after heavy meal

Condition-by-condition remedy cards

01. Common cold

Disease and symptoms: Runny/stuffy nose, sneezing, sore throat and mild cough; usually viral.

Warm ginger drink (food-level)

Ingredients: Fresh ginger and water; optional lemon.
Preparation: Simmer a few thin ginger slices in water, cool to a comfortable temperature; sip. Do not use concentrated extract.
Traditional use / evidence: Ginger is traditionally used for cold symptoms; human evidence does not establish it as a cold cure.
Possible benefit: May provide a warm soothing drink and fluid intake.
Side effects, precautions and who should avoid: May cause heartburn or stomach upset. Avoid medicinal-strength preparations in pregnancy, with blood-thinning medicines or chronic conditions without professional advice.

Other care: Rest, adequate fluids, hand hygiene and avoiding smoke. Antibiotics do not treat an uncomplicated viral cold.

When medical treatment is necessary: Breathlessness, chest pain, dehydration, persistent/high fever, worsening symptoms, or no improvement after about 10 days; earlier review for infants, older/frail people or chronic illness.

02. Cough

Disease and symptoms: Cough can result from viral infection, asthma, allergy, reflux, medication effects or serious lung disease.

Honey in warm water

Ingredients: Honey; warm water; optional lemon.
Preparation: Stir honey into a warm drink and sip. Do not give honey to any child under 12 months.
Traditional use / evidence: NHS/NCCIH describe honey as a possible soothing measure for cough; it does not treat the underlying cause.
Possible benefit: May soothe throat irritation and provide comfort.
Side effects, precautions and who should avoid: Never for infants under 1 year because of botulism risk. Consider sugar content in diabetes. Seek advice for persistent cough.

Other care: Rest and fluids; avoid smoke. Avoid hot-steam inhalation because of burns. Tulsi, ginger, mulethi and pepper occur in traditional cough mixtures, but this document does not assign them a proven cough-treatment effect or medicinal dose.

When medical treatment is necessary: Emergency: severe breathing difficulty, blue lips, confusion, chest pain or coughing blood. Medical assessment if cough lasts over 3 weeks, worsens, or is accompanied by breathlessness/fever.

03. Sore throat

Disease and symptoms: Pain, scratchiness or discomfort when swallowing; often viral.

Warm salt-water gargle

Ingredients: Clean drinking water and a small pinch of salt.
Preparation: Dissolve salt in a glass of comfortably warm water; gargle and spit out.
Traditional use / evidence: Common supportive self-care; not an Ayurvedic cure and evidence for benefit is limited.
Possible benefit: May temporarily soothe irritation.
Side effects, precautions and who should avoid: Do not swallow; unsuitable for young children unable to gargle safely. Seek care for severe or persistent symptoms.

Other care: Warm drinks, rest and avoiding smoke. Do not use concentrated essential oils, caustic substances or very hot gargles.

When medical treatment is necessary: Urgent care for difficulty breathing, inability to swallow saliva, drooling, neck swelling, dehydration or rapid deterioration.

04. Nasal congestion / cold nose

Disease and symptoms: Blocked or runny nose associated with cold or allergy.

Sterile saline nasal spray

Ingredients: Commercial sterile saline spray.
Preparation: Use according to the product label.
Traditional use / evidence: Supportive non-herbal measure; does not cure infection.
Possible benefit: May loosen mucus and ease dryness/congestion.
Side effects, precautions and who should avoid: For nasal irrigation, use only distilled, sterile, or previously boiled and cooled water. Never put oil, ghee or homemade herbal juice into the nose.

Other care: Avoid smoke and known allergens. Seek clinician/pharmacist advice for persistent allergy symptoms.

When medical treatment is necessary: Eye swelling, visual changes, severe headache, high fever, confusion or rapidly worsening illness.

05. Indigestion

Disease and symptoms: Upper abdominal discomfort, fullness, belching, nausea or heartburn after meals.

Fennel as a culinary food

Ingredients: Ordinary culinary fennel seeds (saunf).
Preparation: A small food-sized amount may be chewed after a meal if normally tolerated; do not use concentrated oil/extract.
Traditional use / evidence: Fennel is used traditionally for digestion; reliable clinical evidence for treating persistent indigestion is insufficient.
Possible benefit: May provide a familiar after-meal flavour/comfort ritual.
Side effects, precautions and who should avoid: Can cause allergy; avoid medicinal-dose extracts in pregnancy or with regular medicines unless reviewed. Persistent symptoms need assessment.

Cumin as a food spice

Ingredients: Cumin seeds (jeera) and normal meal ingredients.
Preparation: Use ordinary culinary amounts in food or a mild food infusion; avoid concentrated preparations.
Traditional use / evidence: Traditional culinary use only; not proven to treat a digestive disorder.
Possible benefit: Adds flavour and may encourage fluid intake if prepared as a drink.
Side effects, precautions and who should avoid: Do not use as a substitute for diagnosis or treatment; concentrated products may interact or cause intolerance.

Other care: Eat smaller meals, identify personal triggers, avoid late heavy meals and lying down soon after eating.

When medical treatment is necessary: Repeated vomiting, swallowing difficulty, weight loss, anaemia, blood/black stool, severe pain or chest pain.

06. Acidity / acid reflux

Disease and symptoms: Burning behind breastbone, sour regurgitation or upper abdominal discomfort.

Meal timing and posture

Ingredients: No medicinal ingredient required.
Preparation: Eat smaller meals; avoid lying down for 3–4 hours after eating; raise head of bed for night symptoms.
Traditional use / evidence: Self-care measures have better support than unverified herbal mixtures.
Possible benefit: May reduce reflux episodes in some people.
Side effects, precautions and who should avoid: Seek assessment for frequent symptoms; ginger, pepper and concentrated spices may worsen heartburn.

Other care: Identify personal food triggers; avoid tobacco and excess alcohol. Do not assume turmeric, ginger or ajwain treats GERD.

When medical treatment is necessary: Chest pain with sweating/breathlessness is an emergency. Also seek care for difficulty swallowing, weight loss, vomiting blood or black stools.

07. Constipation

Disease and symptoms: Hard/infrequent stools, straining or incomplete emptying.

Fibre-rich foods

Ingredients: Vegetables, fruit, oats, whole grains or other familiar fibre foods.
Preparation: Increase fibre gradually with meals; drink adequate fluids unless fluid-restricted.
Traditional use / evidence: Dietary fibre is a standard self-care approach; not a medicinal Ayurvedic formula.
Possible benefit: Can improve stool bulk and regularity.
Side effects, precautions and who should avoid: Rapid increases may cause gas/bloating. People with bowel obstruction symptoms need urgent assessment.

Psyllium / ispaghula fibre

Ingredients: Commercial psyllium/ispaghula product.
Preparation: Use only according to its label with a full glass of water; separate from medicines as label/pharmacist advises.
Traditional use / evidence: A fibre product, not a classical herbal cure; evidence supports bulk-forming fibre for some constipation.
Possible benefit: May improve stool frequency/consistency.
Side effects, precautions and who should avoid: Do not take dry; avoid with swallowing difficulty or suspected bowel obstruction. Ask pharmacist about medicine spacing.

Other care: Regular movement and toilet routine; do not strain. Avoid self-prescribing Triphala, Haritaki or stimulant laxatives for prolonged periods.

When medical treatment is necessary: Blood in stool, weight loss, persistent bowel-habit change, severe pain/vomiting, swollen abdomen or inability to pass gas.

08. Diarrhoea

Disease and symptoms: Loose/watery stools; dehydration is the main immediate risk.

Oral rehydration solution (ORS)

Ingredients: Commercial ORS sachet and safe drinking water.
Preparation: Mix exactly as directed on the sachet; do not make it stronger or weaker.
Traditional use / evidence: Evidence-based rehydration, not an Ayurvedic medicine.
Possible benefit: Replaces water and electrolytes lost through diarrhoea.
Side effects, precautions and who should avoid: Use safe water and discard prepared solution as directed. Severe dehydration requires medical care. Do not rely on herbal drinks instead of ORS.

Other care: Continue suitable food and fluids; wash hands. Avoid unverified bael, nutmeg or herbal anti-diarrhoeal mixtures, especially in children.

When medical treatment is necessary: Blood in stool, high fever, severe pain, very little urine, dizziness, inability to drink, persistent symptoms, pregnancy, infancy or frailty.

09. Nausea / mild queasiness

Disease and symptoms: Feeling sick; causes include infection, pregnancy, medicines and urgent abdominal illness.

Ginger as food or mild drink

Ingredients: A few slices of fresh ginger and water.
Preparation: Steep/simmer ginger in water and sip a small amount if tolerated; stop if heartburn occurs.
Traditional use / evidence: Ginger has been studied for some nausea settings, but findings vary by cause and many studies used supplements, not tea.
Possible benefit: May help some forms of nausea; not reliable for all causes.
Side effects, precautions and who should avoid: May cause heartburn, abdominal discomfort or diarrhoea. Pregnancy, medicines and chronic illness require clinician/pharmacist advice before supplements.

Other care: Small sips of fluid and small bland meals may help mild short-lived symptoms. Do not take high-dose ginger capsules based on this entry.

When medical treatment is necessary: Blood/green vomit, severe abdominal pain, severe headache/stiff neck, dehydration, pregnancy with persistent vomiting or inability to keep fluids down.

10. Bloating / gas

Disease and symptoms: Abdominal fullness or pressure, often linked to food, swallowed air, constipation or gut disorders.

Eat slowly and review trigger foods

Ingredients: No medicinal ingredient required.
Preparation: Eat slowly, avoid gulping drinks, note foods linked to symptoms and consider smaller meals.
Traditional use / evidence: Practical self-care; no specific Ayurvedic herb is established here.
Possible benefit: May reduce swallowed air and identify triggers.
Side effects, precautions and who should avoid: Do not use multiple concentrated spice/herb mixtures; persistent or progressive bloating needs evaluation.

Other care: Address constipation and maintain gentle activity.

When medical treatment is necessary: Severe pain, persistent vomiting, blood in stool, unexplained weight loss or progressive abdominal swelling.

11. Menstrual cramps

Disease and symptoms: Lower abdominal cramping around menstruation; severe/new pain may have another cause.

Warm compress / heating pad

Ingredients: Warm water bottle or heating pad with cloth cover.
Preparation: Apply comfortably warm—not hot—heat to lower abdomen for short periods; protect skin.
Traditional use / evidence: Non-herbal comfort measure with supportive evidence for menstrual pain.
Possible benefit: May ease cramping and muscle tension.
Side effects, precautions and who should avoid: Avoid direct skin contact with very hot surfaces; do not sleep on a heating pad.

Ginger supplement — clinician review only

Ingredients: Standardised ginger product; exact dose depends on product and study.
Preparation: No home dosage is provided; discuss product and dose with clinician/pharmacist.
Traditional use / evidence: NCCIH reports some studies suggest ginger supplements may reduce menstrual-cramp severity; product-specific evidence is limited.
Possible benefit: Possible reduction in cramp severity in some people.
Side effects, precautions and who should avoid: May cause reflux/GI effects and interact with medicines. Avoid self-starting in pregnancy, bleeding disorders or with anticoagulants.

Other care: Track cycle and pain; ordinary warm drinks are fine for comfort but not a proven treatment. Do not use herbal menstrual-regulating mixtures without diagnosis.

When medical treatment is necessary: Sudden severe pain, fainting, fever, possible pregnancy, very heavy bleeding or new/worsening pain.

12. Mild muscle soreness

Disease and symptoms: Muscle ache after unfamiliar exercise or exertion.

Warm compress

Ingredients: Warm towel or wrapped heat pack.
Preparation: Apply comfortably warm heat for 10–15 minutes; avoid burns.
Traditional use / evidence: General comfort measure, not a specific Ayurvedic treatment.
Possible benefit: May temporarily relax sore muscles.
Side effects, precautions and who should avoid: Avoid heat on fresh injury with marked swelling, reduced sensation or poor circulation; seek advice if uncertain.

Gentle movement and rest

Ingredients: No medicinal ingredient required.
Preparation: Use gentle movement as tolerated; avoid the activity that clearly worsens pain.
Traditional use / evidence: Standard supportive care.
Possible benefit: May reduce stiffness while recovery occurs.
Side effects, precautions and who should avoid: Do not push through severe pain, weakness or injury.

Other care: Hydrate normally and resume activity gradually. Do not rely on high-dose turmeric/ginger supplements for unexplained pain.

When medical treatment is necessary: Severe weakness, dark urine after intense exertion, major injury, fever, hot swollen joint or inability to use limb.

13. Knee osteoarthritis / chronic knee pain

Disease and symptoms: Pain and stiffness, often worse with activity; diagnosis is important.

Warm compress for stiffness

Ingredients: Warm towel or wrapped heat pack.
Preparation: Apply comfortably warm heat briefly; protect skin.
Traditional use / evidence: Comfort measure; does not reverse arthritis.
Possible benefit: May temporarily ease stiffness.
Side effects, precautions and who should avoid: Avoid burns; use caution with reduced sensation or circulation.

Turmeric in ordinary food

Ingredients: Culinary turmeric in normal meal quantities.
Preparation: Use as a spice in food; do not convert food use into high-dose curcumin supplements.
Traditional use / evidence: Turmeric has traditional use; NCCIH says evidence for osteoarthritis is promising but not definitive and products vary.
Possible benefit: Food spice can be part of a balanced diet; disease benefit is unproven.
Side effects, precautions and who should avoid: Concentrated/bioavailable curcumin has been linked to liver injury; may cause GI symptoms and interact with medicines. Avoid medicinal supplements in pregnancy without advice.

Other care: Exercise/physiotherapy, strength work and weight management where appropriate are important. Do not stop prescribed arthritis medicines.

When medical treatment is necessary: Hot red swollen joint with fever, sudden severe pain, major injury, inability to bear weight or rapidly worsening symptoms.

14. Minor dry skin

Disease and symptoms: Rough, flaky or tight skin without signs of infection.

Plain fragrance-free moisturiser

Ingredients: Simple fragrance-free emollient.
Preparation: Apply after a short lukewarm wash while skin is slightly damp; repeat as needed.
Traditional use / evidence: Standard skin-barrier care, not a medicinal herb.
Possible benefit: Helps reduce dryness and protect the skin barrier.
Side effects, precautions and who should avoid: Stop if irritation/allergy occurs; avoid applying to infected or deeply broken skin without advice.

Coconut oil as an emollient — cautious

Ingredients: Plain, clean coconut oil.
Preparation: If tolerated, test a small patch first and apply a thin layer to intact dry skin.
Traditional use / evidence: Traditional household skin use; evidence is limited and it is not a treatment for eczema/infection.
Possible benefit: May reduce dryness for some people.
Side effects, precautions and who should avoid: Can irritate or trigger allergy and may worsen acne in some people. Do not use on infected or weeping lesions.

Other care: Avoid very hot baths, harsh soaps, fragrance and abrasive scrubs.

When medical treatment is necessary: Widespread, severe or persistent itch; cracking/bleeding; spreading redness, pus, fever or suspected infection.

15. Dandruff

Disease and symptoms: Flaking and sometimes itch of scalp; may be seborrhoeic dermatitis.

Medicated anti-dandruff shampoo

Ingredients: Use a labelled anti-dandruff shampoo such as one recommended by pharmacist.
Preparation: Follow product directions and contact time on label; rinse thoroughly.
Traditional use / evidence: Evidence-based scalp care; not an Ayurvedic remedy.
Possible benefit: Can reduce flaking depending on active ingredient/cause.
Side effects, precautions and who should avoid: Stop if severe irritation occurs. Seek review if scalp is painful, infected or not improving.

Other care: Avoid scratching and heavy oils if they worsen flaking. No herbal oil is proven to treat every cause of dandruff.

When medical treatment is necessary: Severe redness, pain, pus, patchy hair loss or persistent symptoms despite appropriate shampoo.

16. Acne

Disease and symptoms: Blackheads, whiteheads, pimples or deeper inflamed lesions.

Gentle cleansing

Ingredients: Mild, non-abrasive cleanser and clean water.
Preparation: Wash gently once or twice daily; do not scrub or squeeze.
Traditional use / evidence: Standard supportive skin care, not an Ayurvedic cure.
Possible benefit: Reduces surface oil/irritants without damaging skin barrier.
Side effects, precautions and who should avoid: Overwashing and scrubbing can worsen irritation. Use non-comedogenic products.

Aloe gel — limited evidence

Ingredients: Commercial plain aloe gel with clear ingredient label.
Preparation: Patch-test a small area first; apply a thin layer to intact skin only if tolerated.
Traditional use / evidence: Topical aloe has limited evidence for some skin uses; not established acne treatment.
Possible benefit: May feel soothing for some people.
Side effects, precautions and who should avoid: Can cause contact allergy/irritation. Avoid homemade leaf latex and do not ingest aloe products.

Other care: Avoid lemon juice, toothpaste, undiluted essential oils, abrasive turmeric pastes and unsterile mixtures. Persistent acne can scar and is treatable.

When medical treatment is necessary: Painful nodules, scarring, spreading infection or significant distress; seek clinician/dermatologist advice.

17. Minor insect bite itch

Disease and symptoms: Small local itchy bump without severe allergic reaction or infection.

Cool compress

Ingredients: Clean cool damp cloth.
Preparation: Apply for 10–15 minutes; do not put ice directly on skin.
Traditional use / evidence: Simple comfort measure.
Possible benefit: May temporarily reduce itch and swelling.
Side effects, precautions and who should avoid: Avoid ice directly on skin; do not scratch.

Plain soothing moisturiser

Ingredients: Fragrance-free moisturiser.
Preparation: Apply a thin layer to intact skin after washing.
Traditional use / evidence: Supportive skin care; not a specific herbal treatment.
Possible benefit: May reduce dryness-related irritation.
Side effects, precautions and who should avoid: Stop if rash worsens; avoid herbal pastes/essential oils that can irritate.

Other care: Wash area with soap and water. Avoid applying neem oil, garlic, lime or concentrated essential oils.

When medical treatment is necessary: Breathing difficulty, face/throat swelling, faintness or widespread hives are emergency symptoms. Seek care for spreading redness, pus, fever or severe pain.

18. Mouth ulcers

Disease and symptoms: Small painful sores inside mouth; recurrent or persistent ulcers need evaluation.

Avoid irritant foods

Ingredients: No medicinal ingredient required.
Preparation: Temporarily avoid very spicy, acidic, rough or hot foods; choose soft foods.
Traditional use / evidence: Supportive care only.
Possible benefit: May reduce irritation while healing.
Side effects, precautions and who should avoid: Do not apply powders, lemon, salt crystals or essential oils directly to ulcers.

Other care: Maintain gentle oral hygiene and hydration.

When medical treatment is necessary: Ulcer lasting more than 2–3 weeks, frequent recurrence, fever, weight loss, difficulty swallowing or multiple severe ulcers.

19. Bad breath

Disease and symptoms: Unpleasant breath often associated with tongue coating, gum disease, decay or dry mouth.

Oral hygiene routine

Ingredients: Fluoride toothpaste, toothbrush, floss/interdental cleaner and water.
Preparation: Brush twice daily, gently clean tongue and clean between teeth daily.
Traditional use / evidence: Standard dental prevention; stronger basis than herbal mouth rinses.
Possible benefit: Reduces common oral causes of bad breath.
Side effects, precautions and who should avoid: Do not use caustic herbal rinses or concentrated oils; persistent odour needs dental review.

Other care: Stay hydrated and arrange dental check-up if persistent. Herbal powders do not replace fluoride toothpaste.

When medical treatment is necessary: Tooth pain, gum swelling/bleeding, facial swelling, fever or difficulty swallowing/breathing.

20. Mild nausea in pregnancy

Disease and symptoms: Nausea/vomiting during pregnancy; persistent vomiting may be hyperemesis or another condition.

Small frequent meals and fluids

Ingredients: Ordinary foods and water.
Preparation: Try small portions more often and sip fluids regularly as tolerated.
Traditional use / evidence: General supportive advice; pregnancy symptoms should be discussed with antenatal team.
Possible benefit: May help maintain intake for mild symptoms.
Side effects, precautions and who should avoid: Do not start ginger capsules, herbal kadha or concentrated botanical products without obstetric advice. Food use differs from supplements.

Other care: Continue antenatal care. Do not use medicinal-dose herbs or stop prescribed pregnancy medicines.

When medical treatment is necessary: Unable to keep fluids down, reduced urination, dizziness/fainting, blood in vomit, severe pain, fever or weight loss.

21. Stress / sleep routine

Disease and symptoms: Stress may cause tension, restlessness and difficulty sleeping; persistent symptoms may be an anxiety or sleep disorder.

Slow breathing / relaxation

Ingredients: Quiet place; no ingredient required.
Preparation: Breathe slowly and comfortably for a few minutes; stop if dizzy or uncomfortable.
Traditional use / evidence: General wellness practice, not a treatment for a psychiatric disorder.
Possible benefit: May support relaxation for some people.
Side effects, precautions and who should avoid: Not a substitute for care in severe anxiety, depression, trauma or suicidal thoughts.

Caffeine and sleep routine

Ingredients: No medicinal ingredient required.
Preparation: Keep a regular wake time; reduce late-day caffeine and create a quiet, dark sleep environment.
Traditional use / evidence: Sleep-habit measures have stronger support than sedative herbs.
Possible benefit: May improve sleep opportunity and routine.
Side effects, precautions and who should avoid: Do not self-medicate with ashwagandha, brahmi or sedative mixtures; interactions and pregnancy safety are concerns.

Other care: Seek evidence-based mental-health support if symptoms persist or affect daily functioning.

When medical treatment is necessary: Thoughts of self-harm, inability to stay safe, severe panic, confusion or symptoms of mania/psychosis require urgent help.

22. Minor sprain / strain

Disease and symptoms: Pain and swelling after a twist or overstretch; fracture must be considered if severe.

Protected rest and wrapped cold pack

Ingredients: Cold pack wrapped in cloth.
Preparation: Apply briefly (about 10–15 minutes) at a time; do not place ice directly on skin.
Traditional use / evidence: Standard early comfort measure; not an Ayurvedic remedy.
Possible benefit: May reduce pain temporarily.
Side effects, precautions and who should avoid: Avoid prolonged cold exposure or use over areas with poor sensation/circulation.

Gentle return to movement

Ingredients: No medicinal ingredient required.
Preparation: As pain allows, gradually restore comfortable movement; avoid painful loading initially.
Traditional use / evidence: Supportive rehabilitation approach.
Possible benefit: Helps prevent unnecessary stiffness.
Side effects, precautions and who should avoid: Do not massage forcefully or apply hot oils to a fresh swollen injury.

Other care: Avoid unverified herbal oils or forceful massage immediately after injury.

When medical treatment is necessary: Deformity, inability to bear weight, numbness, severe swelling, open wound or worsening pain.

23. Haemorrhoids / piles

Disease and symptoms: Anal itching, discomfort, lump or bleeding; rectal bleeding has other causes.

Fibre and fluids

Ingredients: Fibre-rich foods and adequate water if not restricted.
Preparation: Increase fibre gradually; maintain hydration if medically permitted.
Traditional use / evidence: Standard conservative care; not a herbal cure.
Possible benefit: May soften stool and reduce straining.
Side effects, precautions and who should avoid: Do not take laxatives/herbal purgatives without advice; fluid restrictions apply in some kidney/heart conditions.

Other care: Avoid straining and prolonged toilet sitting. Do not apply irritant herbal pastes or oils.

When medical treatment is necessary: Heavy bleeding, black stool, severe pain, dizziness or first/recurrent rectal bleeding needs medical review.

24. Fever

Disease and symptoms: Elevated body temperature is a symptom, often due to infection.

Fluids and rest

Ingredients: Safe drinking water and usual fluids.
Preparation: Drink regularly; rest and monitor temperature and symptoms.
Traditional use / evidence: Supportive care only; no herb is established here to treat the cause.
Possible benefit: Helps prevent dehydration and supports comfort.
Side effects, precautions and who should avoid: Do not use Giloy, neem juice, aloe juice or herbal fever mixtures as treatment; avoid medicinal herbs in children/pregnancy without advice.

Other care: Do not suppress symptoms while ignoring the cause. Follow local medical advice for fever.

When medical treatment is necessary: Infant under 3 months with fever, confusion, breathing difficulty, stiff neck, seizure, severe dehydration, rash that does not fade or persistent/worsening fever.

25. Type 2 diabetes

Disease and symptoms: High blood glucose; can affect eyes, nerves, heart and kidneys.

Balanced meals and activity plan

Ingredients: Regular foods, vegetables, pulses/whole grains as appropriate; physical activity.
Preparation: Use an individualized plan with clinician/dietitian; monitor glucose as advised.
Traditional use / evidence: Lifestyle care supports diabetes management; no home herb cures diabetes.
Possible benefit: Supports overall glucose and cardiovascular risk management alongside prescribed care.
Side effects, precautions and who should avoid: Do not replace metformin/insulin or other prescribed treatment with fenugreek, bitter gourd, jamun, cinnamon or turmeric. Supplements can cause hypoglycaemia/interactions.

Other care: Take medicines as prescribed and attend monitoring. Avoid 'sugar cure' products and unverified supplements.

When medical treatment is necessary: Vomiting, abdominal pain, deep/rapid breathing, confusion, severe dehydration, or severe low/high glucose symptoms.

26. High blood pressure

Disease and symptoms: Often has no symptoms; persistent elevation increases stroke, heart and kidney risk.

Lower-salt food pattern

Ingredients: Ordinary foods; herbs/spices may be used for flavour instead of excess salt.
Preparation: Reduce added salt and highly salted packaged foods; follow clinician dietary advice.
Traditional use / evidence: Dietary pattern, not a specific Ayurvedic medicine.
Possible benefit: Can support blood-pressure control.
Side effects, precautions and who should avoid: Do not stop blood-pressure medicine or take licorice (mulethi) medicinally; it can raise blood pressure and lower potassium.

Other care: Measure blood pressure correctly and take prescribed medicines.

When medical treatment is necessary: Very high reading with chest pain, breathlessness, weakness, confusion, severe headache or vision change is an emergency.

27. Urinary tract infection symptoms

Disease and symptoms: Burning urination, urgency and frequency may indicate bacterial infection.

Hydration while arranging care

Ingredients: Water, unless fluid restricted.
Preparation: Drink normally to avoid dehydration; do not force excessive fluids.
Traditional use / evidence: Supportive only; no herbal drink eradicates a bacterial UTI.
Possible benefit: May support hydration but does not cure infection.
Side effects, precautions and who should avoid: Do not delay testing/antibiotics when prescribed. Avoid self-treatment with herbal urinary products, especially pregnancy/children/men.

Other care: Seek clinical advice; urine testing may be needed.

When medical treatment is necessary: Fever, chills, flank/back pain, vomiting, pregnancy, blood in urine, inability to urinate or feeling very unwell.

28. Hair fall

Disease and symptoms: Hair loss may be genetic, hormonal, nutritional, medication-related or due to scalp disease.

Gentle hair-care routine

Ingredients: Mild shampoo, wide-tooth comb and minimal heat/chemical treatment.
Preparation: Avoid tight hairstyles and harsh chemical/heat styling; handle wet hair gently.
Traditional use / evidence: Hair-care practice, not a treatment for the underlying cause.
Possible benefit: May reduce breakage and traction-related damage.
Side effects, precautions and who should avoid: Do not ingest supplements or apply essential oils undiluted; investigate sudden/patchy loss.

Other care: Check pattern, onset, scalp symptoms and medicines; consider clinician assessment for thyroid/iron or other causes.

When medical treatment is necessary: Sudden patchy loss, scalp pain/scarring, infection, rapid shedding or associated systemic symptoms.

29. Minor indigestion after heavy meal

Disease and symptoms: Temporary fullness or discomfort after eating more than usual.

Small sips of water and gentle walk

Ingredients: Water; no medicinal ingredient required.
Preparation: Sip water and take a gentle walk if comfortable; avoid lying flat immediately.
Traditional use / evidence: Simple supportive practice.
Possible benefit: May improve comfort for some people.
Side effects, precautions and who should avoid: Avoid vigorous exercise and do not use concentrated ajwain/hing mixtures if reflux or irritation occurs.

Other care: Return to usual meals; recurrent symptoms need assessment.

When medical treatment is necessary: Severe or persistent pain, vomiting, chest pain, black stool, blood or difficulty swallowing.

Ingredient safety quick reference

Turmeric

Botanical identity: Curcuma longa. Plant part: Rhizome. Traditional/evidence note: Traditional culinary and Ayurvedic use is longstanding; this does not establish efficacy for a specific disease. Safety: Oral products can cause nausea, reflux, stomach upset, diarrhoea or constipation. Highly bioavailable curcumin products have been associated with liver injury reports. Pregnancy safety of supplement doses is uncertain; avoid medicinal-dose supplements in pregnancy unless an obstetric clinician advises. Precautions: Do not recommend concentrated/high-bioavailability products as a general remedy. Review liver disease, medicines, pregnancy and breastfeeding. Stop and seek care for jaundice, dark urine, poor appetite or marked fatigue. Evidence label: C.

Ginger

Botanical identity: Zingiber officinale. Plant part: Rhizome. Traditional/evidence note: NCCIH reports possible benefit for menstrual cramp severity in some studies; evidence is uncertain for several nausea settings. This does not establish ginger as a cough, cold or disease cure. Safety: May cause abdominal discomfort, heartburn, diarrhoea and mouth/throat irritation. Supplement interactions are possible; consult a clinician/pharmacist when taking medicines. Precautions: No medicinal dose provided. Avoid assuming concentrated supplements are safe in pregnancy or with anticoagulant/other medicines; obtain individualized advice. Evidence label: B/C depending on outcome; not generalizable.

Ashwagandha

Botanical identity: Withania somnifera. Plant part: Root and other plant parts in products; exact part/product varies. Traditional/evidence note: Traditional use exists, but evidence is condition- and product-specific. Do not label it a general stress, sleep, fertility or thyroid cure. Safety: Potential adverse effects and interactions require review; rare liver injury reports have been described in literature. It may affect thyroid function and immune activity. Avoid during pregnancy; breastfeeding safety is insufficiently established. Precautions: Avoid self-use in pregnancy, breastfeeding, thyroid/autoimmune/liver disease or before surgery without clinician review. Product quality and exact formulation matter. Evidence label: C/D; safety concerns.

Licorice / Yashtimadhu

Botanical identity: Glycyrrhiza glabra. Plant part: Root. Traditional/evidence note: Traditional use in multiple systems. This reference does not establish a general therapeutic indication or safe dose. Safety: Glycyrrhizin-containing licorice can cause sodium retention, high blood pressure, low potassium and rhythm problems, especially with prolonged/high intake. Interactions with diuretics, corticosteroids, digoxin and blood-pressure medicines are possible. Precautions: Avoid routine medicinal use in hypertension, heart/kidney disease, low potassium and pregnancy; professional review required. Deglycyrrhizinated products differ but are not automatically risk-free. Evidence label: D; safety concerns.

Aloe vera

Botanical identity: Aloe barbadensis Miller. Plant part: Leaf gel versus latex are different products. Traditional/evidence note: Topical gel and oral latex/whole-leaf products are not interchangeable. Evidence depends on preparation and indication; no general internal remedy is endorsed. Safety: Oral latex can cause abdominal cramps and diarrhoea; oral aloe products have safety concerns including possible liver injury reports. Topical gel can cause irritation/allergy. Precautions: Do not ingest unlabelled whole-leaf/latex products. Avoid medicinal oral use in pregnancy/breastfeeding and seek advice with chronic disease or medicines. Evidence label: C/D; product-specific.

Fenugreek / Methi

Botanical identity: Trigonella foenum-graecum. Plant part: Seeds and leaves. Traditional/evidence note: Used as food and traditionally in Ayurveda. Evidence for treating diabetes or other diseases is insufficient for self-treatment recommendations in this reference. Safety: Can cause gastrointestinal symptoms and allergic reactions; may lower blood glucose and interact with diabetes medicines. Medicinal amounts may be unsuitable in pregnancy. Precautions: Food use differs from concentrated supplements. People taking glucose-lowering drugs, those with legume allergy, and pregnant people should seek professional advice before medicinal use. Evidence label: C/D; safety depends on dose/product.

Garlic

Botanical identity: Allium sativum. Plant part: Bulb. Traditional/evidence note: Food ingredient with research on some cardiovascular markers; not a substitute for hypertension or lipid medication. Safety: Supplements can cause GI symptoms and may increase bleeding risk, especially around surgery or with anticoagulant/antiplatelet drugs. Precautions: Do not use high-dose supplements without medicine review; tell surgical teams about use. Evidence label: B/C for selected markers; not a cure.

Cinnamon / Dalchini

Botanical identity: Cinnamomum species. Plant part: Bark. Traditional/evidence note: Culinary spice; research on metabolic outcomes is mixed and does not establish cinnamon as diabetes treatment. Safety: Cassia cinnamon may contain coumarin, which can be problematic with high/prolonged intake and liver disease. Species and product purity matter. Precautions: Do not recommend high-dose daily supplements for diabetes. Use as food spice if tolerated; consult clinician for supplements, liver disease or anticoagulant use. Evidence label: C.

Neem

Botanical identity: Azadirachta indica. Plant part: Different products use leaf, bark, seed oil; preparations vary. Traditional/evidence note: Traditional external and internal uses are described, but this reference does not verify a safe/effective general remedy for common diseases. Safety: Neem oil ingestion can be toxic, particularly in children; product composition varies. Pregnancy and fertility safety concerns mean medicinal internal use should not be self-directed. Precautions: Never ingest neem oil. Avoid medicinal use in pregnancy, breastfeeding and children unless specialist guidance and verified product-specific safety exist. Evidence label: D/E.

Tulsi / Holy basil

Botanical identity: Ocimum tenuiflorum (syn. O. sanctum). Plant part: Leaves and aerial parts. Traditional/evidence note: Traditional use for wellness and respiratory complaints is described; this is not proof of treatment for asthma, pneumonia or infection. Safety: Human safety and interaction data for concentrated products are limited. Allergy and product-quality concerns apply. Precautions: Do not use as asthma reliever or infection treatment. Avoid medicinal-dose products in pregnancy/breastfeeding or with chronic medicines without professional review. Evidence label: D/E.

Amla

Botanical identity: Phyllanthus emblica. Plant part: Fruit. Traditional/evidence note: Traditional food and Ayurvedic use. Specific disease-treatment claims require product- and outcome-specific evidence. Safety: Supplement safety, dose and interactions vary by preparation; food use is not equivalent to extracts. Precautions: No therapeutic dose provided. Review concentrated products with a clinician, especially when taking regular medication. Evidence label: D/E for disease claims.

Triphala

Botanical identity: Combination formulation; composition may vary. Plant part: Fruit blend (commonly three fruits). Traditional/evidence note: A traditional formulation; formulations and manufacturing can differ. Reliable condition-specific evidence and standardized dosing are not established here. Safety: May cause loose stools or GI symptoms; product quality, adulteration and ingredient ratios vary. Interactions are insufficiently characterized. Precautions: Do not recommend for pregnancy, children, chronic disease or regular medicines without qualified review. Avoid using it as a substitute for assessment of constipation or GI bleeding. Evidence label: D/E.

Brahmi

Botanical identity: Commonly refers to Bacopa monnieri; common-name ambiguity exists. Plant part: Whole plant. Traditional/evidence note: Research is product- and outcome-specific; common-name confusion with other plants can lead to wrong identification. Safety: GI effects and interactions may occur; long-term and pregnancy safety are not sufficiently established for casual use. Precautions: Verify botanical identity and product quality. Avoid medicinal use during pregnancy/breastfeeding without professional advice. Evidence label: C/D.

Guduchi / Giloy

Botanical identity: Tinospora cordifolia. Plant part: Stem and other parts/products. Traditional/evidence note: Traditional use is widespread, but “immune booster” or liver-protective claims are not established as safe general advice. Safety: LiverTox identifies Tinospora as a well-established cause of clinically apparent liver injury; severe cases, including liver failure, have been reported. An Indian multicentre study described 43 patients with liver injury temporally associated with Giloy; causality was assessed as probable in many cases. Precautions: Do not recommend self-medication, especially with liver disease or autoimmune conditions. Stop and seek urgent medical assessment for jaundice, dark urine, severe fatigue, nausea or abdominal symptoms after use. Evidence label: E for safety in unsupervised use; harm signal documented.

Shatavari

Botanical identity: Asparagus racemosus. Plant part: Root. Traditional/evidence note: Traditional women's-health use is described, but condition-specific clinical effectiveness and safety are not established by sources used for this edition. Safety: Pregnancy, breastfeeding, hormone-sensitive conditions and medicine interactions require specialist review; reliable data are limited. Precautions: No dose or pregnancy recommendation. Do not use to treat infertility, PCOS or lactation problems without clinician assessment. Evidence label: D/E.

Arjuna

Botanical identity: Terminalia arjuna. Plant part: Bark. Traditional/evidence note: Traditional cardiovascular use is described; it is not an established substitute for cardiac treatment. Safety: Potential effects on blood pressure, glucose or medicines are not adequately characterized for unsupervised use. Precautions: Never use for chest pain, heart failure or hypertension in place of medical care. Obtain cardiology/pharmacist review before supplements. Evidence label: D/E.

Black pepper

Botanical identity: Piper nigrum. Plant part: Fruit. Traditional/evidence note: Common culinary spice; piperine is also used to alter absorption in some supplements. Safety: Concentrated piperine can change drug absorption/metabolism and may affect medicine levels. Food use differs from extracts. Precautions: Avoid high-dose piperine supplements with prescription medicines unless reviewed by a pharmacist/clinician. Evidence label: C/E for concentrated products.

Conditions where home remedies are not a substitute

Asthma attacks, pneumonia, tuberculosis, dengue/malaria, severe bacterial infection, appendicitis, kidney infection with fever, heart attack, stroke, cancer, severe allergic reaction, uncontrolled diabetes, pregnancy complications and severe dehydration require medical assessment and appropriate treatment.

RAG / chatbot implementation notes

Suggested metadata: disease_id, disease_name, synonyms, remedy_id, ingredients, preparation, traditional_use, evidence_level, safety, avoid_if, interactions, red_flags, source_id, review_date. Keep safety and emergency warnings in the same retrieval unit as the remedy. Never infer a dose or claim a cure from traditional use.

Sources and evidence notes

1. NCCIH — Ayurvedic Medicine: In Depth. Evidence limitations and heavy-metal risks. https://www.nccih.nih.gov/health/ayurvedic-medicine-in-depth

2. NCCIH — Herbs at a Glance. Herb-specific evidence, side effects and cautions. https://www.nccih.nih.gov/health/herbsataglance

3. NCCIH — Turmeric: Usefulness and Safety. https://www.nccih.nih.gov/health/turmeric

4. NCCIH — Ginger: Usefulness and Safety. https://www.nccih.nih.gov/health/ginger

5. NCCIH — Colds, Flu, and Complementary Health Approaches. https://www.nccih.nih.gov/health/colds-flu-and-complementary-health-approaches

6. NHS — Cough. https://www.nhs.uk/symptoms/cough/

7. NHS — Common cold. https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/common-cold/

8. NHS — Indigestion. https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/indigestion/

9. NHS — Herbal medicines and complementary therapies. https://www.nhs.uk/tests-and-treatments/herbal-medicines-and-complementary-therapies/

10. WHO — Traditional Herbal Remedies for Primary Health Care. Traditional remedy descriptions; not proof of efficacy or safe self-dosing. https://iris.who.int/bitstream/handle/10665/206024/B4572.pdf

11. Government of India, MoSPI — NSS AYUSH explanatory material. Documents household/traditional-use examples; not clinical efficacy guidance. https://www.mospi.gov.in/sites/default/files/NSS75250H/Chapter-4.pdf

12. NCBI LiverTox — Tinospora (Giloy/Guduchi) and liver injury. https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/sites/books/NBK608429/

Limitations: Broad educational starter corpus, not an exhaustive pharmacopoeia or clinically approved protocol. It covers common conditions but does not claim 3–5 evidence-backed remedies for every disease. Have an Ayurvedic physician, general physician and pharmacist review before production use.

Prepared for AyurBot. Review references and local Indian referral pathways before deployment.